

Power & tensions mapping

What this tool produces · *A critical, visual synthesis mapping the visible, hidden, and invisible forms of power exerted by different actors, revealing whose voices are prioritized and whose are marginalized,.*

G1 · Proof of Impact

Dimensions

Social / User

Regulation

Preparing the workshop · *Power & tensions mapping*

G1 · Proof of Impact

Why this tool matters

Refusing the polite illusion of equality; courageously naming the underlying conflicts and financial pressures so that the community can negotiate its future with its eyes wide open.

Evidence we produce

A critical, visual synthesis mapping the visible, hidden, and invisible forms of power exerted by different actors, revealing whose voices are prioritized and whose are marginalized,.

Duration & Material

Duration · 3 to 6 weeks of qualitative research and mapping

Material · Power Matrix templates, stakeholder interview guides, network visualization tools

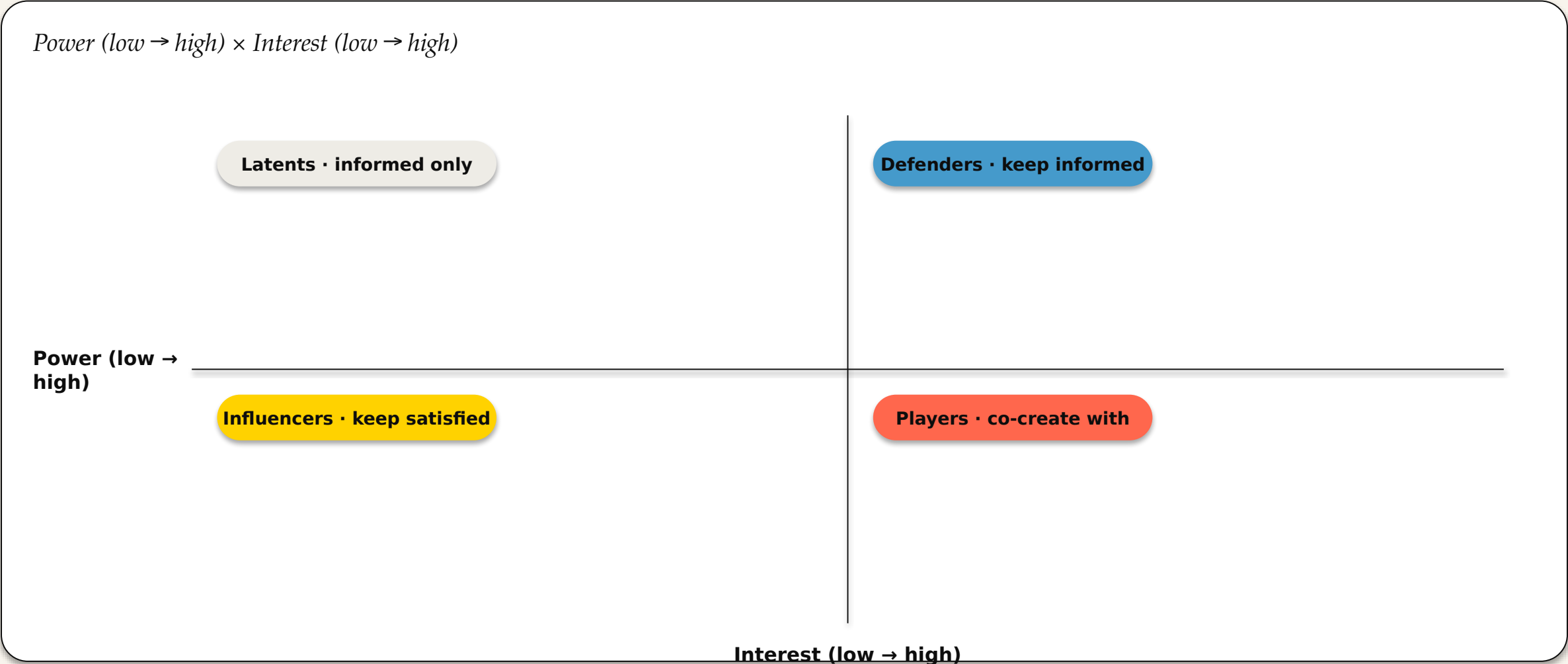
Reference case

In peri-urban Nigeria, researchers utilized power-mapping synthesis informed by Lukes' dimensions of power to assess collaborative governance. By identifying the visible, hidden, and invisible mechanisms of power shaping participation, they proved that traditional, "neutral" planning processes routinely marginalized women and informal workers, necessitating power-sensitive governance arrangements to achieve true sustainable development,.

Suggested agenda · Brief (10 min) > Method walk-through (15 min) > Animation canvas (60-90 min) > Harvest (20 min)

Power × interest matrix · with tension lines

Duration
3 to 6 weeks of qualitative research and mapping



Add tension lines between actors to show where conflict simmers.

Harvesting our *learnings*

After running the canvas, capture three layers of insight.

What inspires me

Stand-out signals, surprising stories, ideas to remember

How to apply it here

Concrete adaptations to our context, our team, our constraints

What we need to be autonomous

Skills, allies, resources, decisions still to secure

Each participant fills a copy. Then debrief together to surface patterns and next steps.